

that you hold down to talk might actually be a far better UI than even the best designed vernacular keyboard. As we said before, the problems are unique, and solutions might need a larger focus on R&D in some of these unique areas.

FUN AND GAMES

Stemming from our arrogance is the idea that the internet should be a tool that is used by the poor to uplift themselves, and nothing more. Some of us might probably consider it a waste to give them high bandwidth access, or want to block off access to entertainment, or porn, or all of the fun things we do. We certainly cannot imagine them watching Netflix, and especially not Netflix and chilling! They're poor. How dare they try and have fun instead of earning more money!

If that's what someone thinks, then they're part of the arrogance problem. Who are we to tell people, no matter where they live or how much they survive on, what they should use the Internet for? If a labourer wants to watch Comedy Nights with Kapil after a long hard day of work, who the heck are we to judge him for it? Or if he

wants to stream the Cricket World Cup like everyone else, do people think that's not relevant to him because he's poor? Heck, if he wants to spend his data on two hours of TikTok a day, why should it bother anyone else?

In fact, studies have shown that lower income segments want content from Bollywood, want to watch cricket matches and also want various religious-based content and services. Music, especially, is a wild draw, and music apps (usually from the provider they use) are doing very well. Plans that bundle access to all of this are popular, even if they're not the cheapest plan available. Of course, this is data that comes from the already connected, so perhaps it is not truly indicative of the next billion, but it's a place to start at instead of shooting in the dark.

As smartphones get cheaper and also perform faster at the lowest price

bands, eventually penetration will increase, and feature phones will die out. Or so we assume. Maybe smartphones, the way

they're designed now, are too daunting to the next billion, and they prefer their feature phones. Android might just be too complex, with way too many options and settings to be adopted by the next billion, and sure, Android One might be the way to go, or it might not. A lot depends on UX design, and feedback from those users.

or schemes, or ways we haven't even thought of yet, the next billion women are going to come online in droves, and this means apps and services catering to their needs will do well.

As sexist as it sounds to us, the traditional role of the woman in rural India is still homemaker and child carer (often in addition to part time or full time work), and this involves a myriad of tasks that they would love to get some help with. Services that can make those aspects of their lives easier, and free up some time for leisure for them,

will be the ones that will resonate. And the problems are all going to be localised, so we can forget about the one-size-fits-all solutions for the most part.

If 200 million women from rural India logged on to the Internet the way it is now, will they find much value? This is where targeted startups and even government schemes will come to the forefront. Whether it's simple recipe ideas, or homemaking tricks, or even on demand serials in vernacular languages, services that cater to

whatever it is rural women are interested in, are going to take off in a big way. That's going to shape and change the demographic of the Indian internet user, and also change the way some services appear to us. Shopping sites are going to crop up that cater to them, so will fintech companies wanting to digitise their transactions, and who really knows what the Indian Internet will look like when there is an equal representation of both sexes?

PRIVACY BE DAMNED

We care about privacy, and are concerned about what cookie is tracking us, or what service is storing information, etc. The next billion might not care as much, or even at all. They don't care if you can see their photos on social media, or videos, or



Ludo King, one of the most successful mobile games in India.

WOMEN

Some estimates suggest that in poorer social groups, women are less than 50% as likely to get access to the

Internet as their male relatives.

We have to face facts; we still live in a society where the education, entertainment and happiness of women comes a distant second to the only other competitor – men. Girls and women are of lowest priority when it comes to paying for technology access in a family.

Now we can sit about and lament the facts, or we can realise that this means that the majority of the next billion are women. In a way, this makes the challenge of getting them online a little harder, but that's where all the corporate interest in the next billion will play a role. Using ad campaign money,